सत्यमेव जयते

F No. 9/1/2026-CD(Cen)
भारत सरकार/Government of India
गृह मंत्रालय/Ministry of Home Affairs
भारत के महारजिस्ट्रार एवं जनगणना आयुक्त का कार्यालय
Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner, India
जनगणना भवन, टावर-ए, 2-ए,मान सिंह रोड,नई दिल्ली-110011
Janganana Bhawan, Tower-A, 2/A, Man Singh Road,
New Delhi-110011.

दिनांक: 17.03.2026

CENSUS OF INDIA 2027 - CIRCULAR No. 16

Subject: - Duties of the Census Officers

The preparations for the ensuing Census 2027 are at an advanced stage. The first phase of the Census of India 2027 i.e. Houselisting and Housing Census will be conducted during April-September, 2026 in States and UTs during the period of thirty days as notified by each State and Union territory with an option for self-enumeration to be conducted in a fifteen days' time period just before the start of house to house houselisting operations of thirty days. The period and questionnaire of the second phase i.e. Population Enumeration will be notified in due course of time. The appointment of State/UT Nodal Officer, Divisional Census Officers, Principal Census Officers, District Census Officers, Sub-Divisional Census Officers and Charge Officers, etc., have been completed in almost all the States/UTs. Training to the officers at the State, District and Tahsil Headquarters is in progress. Subsequent to the completion of training of Principal Census Officers, District Census Officers and Charge Officers, the training to the Enumerators and Supervisors will commence for Houselisting & Housing Census.

2. The Census taking in the country is carried out under the provisions of the Census Act, 1948 and Census Rules, 1990 and the amendments made

thereunder from time to time. The functions of the Census Officers have been contained in Rule 5 of the Census Rules. For smooth conduct of Census Operations, it is necessary that the Census Officers engaged in conducting of Houselisting & Housing Census and Population Enumeration must be informed of their specific duties under the Census Act. Along with the duties, penalties have also been prescribed under Section 11 of the Census Act, 1948. The specific duties and responsibilities of the Principal Census Officers, District/Additional District or Sub-Divisional Census Officers, Charge Officers, Supervisors and Enumerators are elaborated below:

3. The Principal Census Officer shall, -

a. cause the required number of District or Sub-Divisional Census Officers or Charge Officers to be appointed for taking census in the district or municipal corporation or panchayat area, etc.;

b. take, aid in and supervise the houselisting and taking of the census within the limit of the district or municipal corporation or panchayat areas, town area committee/notified areas and the like and forward the result alongwith the filled in schedules and blank forms, in case where enumerator uses paper schedule in unavoidable circumstances, to the Director of Census Operations within the period specified by him;

c. arrange training to Enumerators, Supervisors and Charge Officers so as to enable them to perform their duties efficiently and within the time specified by the Director of Census Operations;

d. take action and prosecute any defaulting person with the previous sanction of the State Government or of an authority authorised in this behalf by the State Government;

e. create District/M.Corp user, Charge Admin and Charge User within her/his jurisdiction;

f. create user-id of Field Trainer and complete the activities like creation of training batch, nomination, completion of training and updating of attendance in Census Management and Monitoring Systems (CMMS) portal.

g. view/monitor progress of work in District/Charges through CMMS Portal and also by making field visits;

h. ensure forwarding of filled-in schedules/ forms, if any to the Director of Census Operations

i. carry out such other tasks as may be necessary for the successful taking of the census.

4. The District/Additional District or Sub-Divisional Census Officer shall

a. (i) cause the required number of Charge Officers and other census officers in a District or Sub-district to be appointed;

(ii) cause the entire area of a District to be divided into well demarcated census divisions, namely, charges, supervisor's circles and Houselisting blocks as per instruction issued in this behalf by the Director of Census Operations;

(iii) cause the up-to-date list of Villages and Towns to be compiled and their jurisdictional maps prepared;

(iv) assist the Director of Census Operations in compiling the related statistical data as per requirement;

(v) give proper publicity to census programmes from time to time so as to get proper responses from the public;

b. To impart training to Charge Officers and cause proper training to be imparted to Supervisors and Enumerators through Charge Officers so as to enable them to perform their duties efficiently and

c. To assist the Principal Census Officers to take, aid in and supervise the houselisting and taking of Census within the limits of the Districts, Municipal Corporations, Panchayats etc.

d. CMMS related duties:

(i) To assist the Principal Census Officer to create District/M.Corp user, Charge admin and Charge user in CMMS portal within his/ her jurisdiction

(ii)To assist the Principal Census Officer to create user-id of Field Trainer and complete the activities like creation of training batch, nomination, completion of training and updating of attendance in Census Management and Monitoring Systems (CMMS) portal.

(iii) View/monitor progress of work in District/Charges through CMMS Portal and also by making field visits.

(iv) Ensure that all digital entries of the various schedules, whether complete, partially complete, or pending, along with abstracts or any other required

statements prepared by the Enumerators, are uploaded and submitted through the designated census application/portal.

e. collect the filled-in and blank forms of the various Schedules along with abstracts or any other statement that may be required to be prepared by the Enumerators;

f. forward the filled in/partially filled in or blank forms, if any of each schedule along with one copy of layout map of the HLB/EB and signed copy of Charge Register of each charge or any other statement for district through the Department of Post to the Director of Census Operations for the State or Union Territory Administration.

g. consolidate the Summary of Enumerator's abstract or statement for the entire District;

h. carry out such other tasks as may be necessary for the successful taking of the census;

5. The Charge Officer shall -

a. i) cause the required number of Supervisors and Enumerators to be appointed within the jurisdiction of her/his charge (including reserve Enumerators and Supervisors);

ii) ensure creation of the user account of Supervisors and Enumerators, working in the Charge, through CMMS Portal;

iii) generate and issue Appointment Letter and Identity Card to Supervisors/ Enumerators;

iv) tracking and management of Printing and Logistics;

v) overall monitoring, management and supervision of activities through dashboard and report modules of CMMS.

b. motivate the Enumerators to use the Mobile App for collection of data;

c. facilitate data entry on web portal at Charge office from Schedules in case the Enumerator has completed the field work by filling up of Schedules manually;

d. cause formation of Houselisting Block (HLBs) and Supervisory Circles for Houselisting and Housing Census through HLBC Web Mapping Application and Enumeration Blocks (EBs) for Population Enumeration as per the stipulated guidelines in consultation with Director of Census Operations;

e. ensure proper identification and preparation of Layout Maps of HLBs for Houselisting and Housing Operations and EBs for Population Enumeration by the field functionaries;

f. i) familiarise himself/herself with the enumeration instructions and cause the Supervisors and Enumerators to be trained so as to enable them to perform their duties efficiently;

ii) select suitable training venue(s) with proper ventilation, electricity, drinking water facility, Internet facility (preferably Wi-Fi) and sitting arrangement for approx. 40-45 field functionaries (Enumerators/ Supervisors) and ensure that the training is conducted smoothly;

iii) nominate Supervisors/Enumerators for training and update their training details;

iv) co-ordinate with local Post Office for receipt of Census materials, Kit items, Working Maps, etc., supplied by Office of Registrar General, India (ORGI) and Directorate of Census Operations (DCOs);

v) ensure that training material is distributed to the Enumerators/Supervisors before training;

g. prepare basic documents like Village/Town Register and Charge Register for Houselisting & Housing Census as well as Population Enumeration separately, in the prescribed format as per instructions from the ORGI within the time schedule;

h. ensure that the auto-generated Abridged Houselist (AHL) with pre-filled Section 1 & 2, as available in the CMMS Portal for each Enumeration Block (EB), is printed and provided to the respective Enumerator;

i. ensure complete coverage of HLB/EB by field functionaries without omission and duplication;

j. monitor the progress of field work at each stage, by making field visits and through CMMS Portal, and ensure completion of work as per given timeline;

k. inspect field work to ensure the quality of Census data;

l. i) ensure collection of the filled in and blank Schedules from Enumerators/Supervisors where the data collection is done on Paper Schedule in unavoidable circumstances;

ii) dispatch filled-in Schedules and other forms/materials which include layout map and Charge register to DCO/District as per the instructions to be provided separately by the ORGI.

m. provide provisional population figures to the Census Commissioner, through the Director of Census Operations within a week on completion of census operations;
n. consolidate the summary of Enumerator's abstract of various Enumeration Blocks and statements and forward these to the District Census Officers or Sub-divisional Officers along with the filled-in and blank Schedules;
o. ensure strict adherence to the time schedule;
p. certify that Enumerators and Supervisors under her/his jurisdiction has attended the training program and completed the work ; and
q. carry out such other tasks as may be necessary for the successful taking of the census.

6. The Supervisor shall –

a. download and install the Mobile App from Google Play Store/Apple App store only and register her/his device
b. ensure that all the Enumerators attached to her/him attend training and receive materials during raining;
c. identify the jurisdiction/area of all Enumerators under her/his supervision by visiting all HLBs/EBs with concerned Enumerators to finalize boundary of each HLB/EB;
d. use the downloaded pdf copy of Maps pertaining to the Supervisory Circle allotted from HLO App as reference to draw Layout Map of Supervisory Circle showing important landmarks, natural features, boundaries of each HLB/EB allotted to the Enumerators working under the Supervisor;
e. check all the records through Mobile App along with SE data after synchronization of the data by Enumerator;
f. ensure that data entry is completed on the web portal at Charge Officer's office within the prescribed date if data collection is carried out in paper mode by any of the Enumerator.
g. assist the Enumerators under her/his jurisdiction and ensure that work is done as per prescribed time Schedule;
h. ensure that there is complete coverage of area, houses, households and household members in all the HLBs/EBs assigned to the Enumerators under her/his supervision;

i. move independently to check that no area between HLBs/EBs is left out;
j. assist the Enumerator for enumeration of Houseless households in the night of last day of enumeration during Population Enumeration phase of Census;
k. ensure completeness of allotted work by all Enumerators under her /his supervision either through mobile apps or in all filled-in forms;
l. collect the filled-in, blank forms, required statements and Certificate of complete coverage from all concerned Enumerators;
m. forward the documents, duly signed, to the Charge Officer within two days of completion of Census operations;
n. attend to all other tasks related to Census assigned from time to time by the Charge Officer.

7. The Enumerator shall -
a. download and install the Mobile App from Google Play Store/Apple App store only and register her/his device only after Houselisting Block (HLB)/Enumeration Block (EB) allotment is done in CMMS Portal by the Charge Officer;
b. download the HLB Map from HLO Mobile App/ EB map from PE Mobile App and prepare Layout Map of the allotted Houselisting Block (HLBs)/ Enumeration Block(s) as per the boundaries shown in HLB Map;
c. show all buildings with numbers, number of census houses in each building and other important Landmarks on the Layout Map;
d. assign number to each Building and Census House;
e. carry appointment letter along with ID Card during the field visit;
f. conduct proper probing while maintaining a polite behavior during the field visit;
g. fill up the data in mobile app during door to door visit according to instructions issued;
h. Collect the SE IDs of households who have done Self-Enumeration and review the data and confirm from respondent before accepting or editing ;
i. ensure that all the houses/households are covered under her/his jurisdiction;
j. make multiple visits, if the Census House was found locked;
k. undertake the revision round and updating of records through mobile App;

l. ensure that entire assigned area is covered without omission and duplication;
m. if data is collected on Paper Schedule due to unavoidable circumstances, ensure data entry on the web portal at Charge Office;
n. handover all documents, filled-in, partially filled-in and blank forms to the Supervisors if data collection is carried out in Paper mode.

8. Penalties under Section 11-

(1) a) any census officer or any person lawfully required to give assistance towards the taking of census who refuses to perform any duty imposed upon her/him by this Act or any rule made there under, or any person who hinders or obstructs another person in performing any such duty, or
aa) any census officer or any person lawfully required to give assistance towards the taking of a census who neglects to use reasonable diligence in performing any duty imposed upon her/him or in obeying any order issued to her/him in accordance with this Act or any rule made there under or any person who hinders or obstructs another person in performing any such duty or obeying any such order, or;
b) any census officer who intentionally puts any offensive or improper question or knowingly makes any false return or, without the previous sanction of the Central Government or the State Government, disclose any information which she/he has received by means of, or for the purposes, of a census return, or
c) any sorter, compiler or other member of the census staff who removes, secrets, damages or destroys any census documents or deals with any census document in a manner likely to falsify or impair the tabulation of census results,

shall be punishable with fine which may extend to one thousand rupees and in case of a conviction under part (a), (b) or (c) shall also be punishable with imprisonment which may extend to three years;
(2) Whoever abets any offence under Sub-section (1) shall be punishable with fine which may extend to one thousand rupees.

9. All State governments/ Union Territories are, therefore, requested to circulate the specific duties of the different levels of Census Officers to the concerned functionaries and bring it to their notice. Kindly submit a compliance report in this regard to this office.

Narayanan 17/3/2026

(Mritunjay Kumar Narayan)
Registrar General & Census Commissioner of India
Telephone: 011-23388132
Email: rgi.rgi@gov.in

The Chief Secretary,
All States/UTs.

Copy to:

1. State/UT Census Nodal Officers
2. Director of Census Operations, All Directorates
3. Additional RG (S/SK)/DDG
4. All Divisional Heads of the ORGI including Language Division, Kolkata
5. Guard File/Order File